SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #10 · RACE, ETHNICITY AND LANGUAGE

"I'm less valuable because of where I come from."

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Where it often comes from

Mockery of an accent, a neighborhood, or a country, or being treated as a representative of a stereotype, teaches us that our origin is a defect. Over time, we may apologize for it, hide it, or conclude it makes us less.

What Scripture teaches

"Can anything good come from Nazareth?" Nathanael asked, and Philip answered, "Come and see." Jesus Himself grew up in a despised town. Scripture says, "From one man He made every nation of men," and that God "determined their appointed times and the boundaries of their lands." "The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is Maker of them all." We are each "fearfully and wonderfully made." Our place of birth is part of our story, but it is not a measure of our worth.

> *"From one man He made every nation of men, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and He determined their appointed times and the boundaries of their lands"* (Acts 17:26).

Also see

> "'Can anything good come from Nazareth?' Nathanael asked. 'Come and see,' said Philip" (John 1:46).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is Maker of them all" (Proverbs 22:2).

> "Here there is no Greek or Jew, circumcised or uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave, or free, but Christ is all and is in all" (Colossians 3:11).

Common self-statements

- Where I come from is a disadvantage.
- I should be ashamed of my background.
- My accent marks me as lesser.
- People from my place are worth less.
- I have to hide my origin.
- I started behind and will stay behind.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Letting a place define my worth.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that my origin is shameful.
- Mental filter: Focusing on disadvantages and missing strengths.
- Mind reading: Assuming others look down on me.

Challenging questions

- What was good about the place I come from?
- Who taught me to be ashamed, and what did they gain?

- What strengths did I gain from my origin?
- What does Scripture say about nations and places?
- How did Jesus' hometown look to others?
- How might I honor my origin and still grow?

Truth summary

> My worth comes from being made by God, not from my place of birth. My origin shaped me, and it is part of my story. I can tell it with honesty and dignity.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Prejudice
- Guilt/Shame
- Humility
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Judgmental

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Dear Younger Me — MercyMe
Past wounds and choices do not have to become a person's permanent identity.

Hello My Name Is — Matthew West
God's redeemed-child identity challenges labels of regret and defeat.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm less valuable because of where I come from"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm less valuable because of where I come from." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What was good about my origin?
- ☐ Who taught me shame?
- ☐ What strengths do I have?
- ☐ What does God say?
- ☐ How can I honor my roots?
- ☐ Who can I tell?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God made every nation from one man.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ Good can come from small places.
- ☐ The Lord is Maker of us all.
- ☐ My origin is part of my story.
- ☐ I do not have to hide.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Acts 17:26
  "From one man He made every nation of men, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and He determined their appointed times and the boundaries of their lands."
- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ John 1:46
  "'Can anything good come from Nazareth?' Nathanael asked. 'Come and see,' said Philip."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Roots I honor: Each week, note one strength from your origin.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Acts 17:26 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God made every nation, and my origin is part of His design.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] List what was good. Write five good things about where you come from.
- [ ] Name the shame. Write who taught it and what is false.
- [ ] Share your story. Tell someone about your place.
- [ ] Honor your roots. Cook, visit, or call in a way that honors where you came from.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm less valuable because of where I come from": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A root I honor
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm less valuable because of where I come from.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You made me and placed me in my time and place. Free me from shame about where I come from, and help me honor it with dignity. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.